agriculture a non-business function. Third, agriculture is subject to so many restrictive laws—ceiling, leasing, contracting, marketing, essential commodities and so on—which no other economic activity is subject to, resulting in a total loss of enterprise.

India can neither build a $10 trillion economy nor achieve the goal of fair distribution of incomes and wealth unless agriculture is freed from these emasculating legislative controls, released from the yoke of all pervasive government support and its resource use (labour, land and water) made more proportional to the value it adds. This calls for a comprehensive reform and restructuring agenda.

India was late to join the bandwagon of industry. Today, we lag behind massively in manufacturing on account of this late acceptance of industrialization. The world seems to be getting adequately industrialized on the whole. This is making global supply of industrial goods meet global demand. Reduced growth rates of population, maturing of consumption of industrial goods in advanced economies and productivity introduced by digitalization (Industry 4.0) and global value chains seem to indicate that the opportunity of adding growth and jobs by investing in manufacturing will be much less attractive than in the digitalization of economies. Our industry has lot of obsolescence as well.

An appropriate policy framework to make India industrially competitive and focus industrialization on sectors and niches where we can be global leaders would make the real difference in building India’s $10 trillion economy.

These fundamental reforms are developed into specific sectoral reform packages in the ensuing chapters.